# The newer model isn't always the comparable one.

A 2021 Samsung Q80A QLED needs a replacement. A quick search finds a newer "Neo QLED" at $699.99, but Samsung's own sheet shows it falls short of the original in three ways. Item Assist compares replacements against the original's documented specifications, not price position or branding.

Summary: reported age, researched age and documented market price (observed November 9, 2026)

| ITEM | REPORTED | RESEARCHED | AGE STATUS | DOCUMENTED MARKET PRICE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Samsung Q80A TV | 2021 | 2021, model year | Model Year Confirmed | $899.99 · QN55QN80H · Best Buy |
| Samsung RF28R7201SR | Not provided | Not established | Age Evidence Needed | $1,899.99 · same model · Best Buy |
| GE GFD65ESSNWW dryer | 2025 | Dec 2019 – Aug 2023 (model) | Reported Age Requires Review | $899.00 · GFD65ESSVWW · GE.com, Home Depot |
| **Total documented replacement value, three items** | | | | **$3,698.98** |

## ORIGINAL ITEM Samsung QN55Q80AAFXZA

2021 Q80A, 55-inch QLED · No longer sold new at Best Buy

**DISPLAY**
QLED with quantum dot color
SAMSUNG

**BACKLIGHT**
Direct Full Array
SAMSUNG

**NATIVE REFRESH RATE**
120Hz (55-inch size)
THIRD-PARTY: RTINGS
Samsung's sheet does not state a native rate

**4K@120HZ HDMI INPUT**
One port (HDMI 4)
SAMSUNG

**VARIABLE REFRESH RATE**
Yes, all ports (FreeSync Premium Pro)
SAMSUNG

| SPECIFICATION | LOWER-PRICED CANDIDATE<br>Samsung QN55QN70H<br>$699.99<br>Documented at Best Buy · Nov 9, 2026 | SELECTED LKQ CANDIDATE<br>Samsung QN55QN80H<br>$899.99<br>Documented at Best Buy · Nov 9, 2026 | HIGHER-PRICED CANDIDATE<br>Samsung QN55S90H<br>$1,199.99<br>Documented at Best Buy · Nov 9, 2026 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Display technology**<br>Original: QLED, quantum dot | ✓ MEETS<br>Quantum dot Mini LED LCD (Neo QLED) | ✓ MEETS<br>Quantum dot Mini LED LCD (Neo QLED) | ▲ UPGRADE<br>OLED, a different display technology |
| **Backlight**<br>Original: Direct Full Array | ✓ MEETS<br>Mini LED backlight with Supreme Mini LED Dimming | ✓ MEETS<br>Quantum Mini LED, full array, with Supreme Mini LED Dimming | ▲ UPGRADE<br>No backlight; self-lit pixels |
| **Native refresh rate**<br>Original: 120Hz, per RTINGS | ✗ SHORTFALL<br>60Hz. Samsung also lists a 120Hz "DLG" mode that reduces image sharpness | ✓ MEETS<br>144Hz (Samsung: VRR support) | ▲ UPGRADE<br>165Hz (Samsung: VRR support) |
| **4K@120Hz HDMI input**<br>Original: one port | ✗ SHORTFALL<br>None. Maximum 4K@60Hz, on 3 HDMI ports | ✓ MEETS<br>All 4 HDMI ports, maximum input 4K@144Hz | ▲ UPGRADE<br>All 4 HDMI ports, maximum input 4K@165Hz |
| **Variable refresh rate**<br>Original: yes | ✗ SHORTFALL<br>Not supported (Samsung lists VRR and FreeSync as N/A) | ✓ MEETS<br>Yes, AMD FreeSync Premium Pro | ✓ MEETS<br>Yes, AMD FreeSync Premium Pro |
| **Conclusion** | ✗ SHORTFALL<br>**Does not meet the original's documented specifications** | ✓ MEETS<br>**Meets every specification checked** | ▲ UPGRADE<br>**Exceeds the original; a different tier** |

**Why not the QN70H.** It costs $200 less than the QN80H, but Samsung lists 60Hz, no VRR and a 4K@60Hz maximum.

**Why the QN80H.** It matches or exceeds the original on every specification checked, not because it is the middle price. It is not presented as the lowest-priced suitable Samsung; a 2025 QN80F at $827.95 is unresolved.

## Refrigerator: when the original is still sold new

**Original:** Samsung RF28R7201SR, 4-door, FlexZone drawer, external water and ice dispenser. Still sold new at Best Buy for $1,899.99.

**Look-alikes each change something.** The 3-door RF32CG5B30SR ($1,799.99) has no FlexZone; the Bespoke RF29BB8600QL ($2,199.99) has no external dispenser and a smaller FlexZone. The identical model removed the question.

**Documented market prices.** Retailer selling prices observed on November 9, 2026, during promotions (Black Friday and Holiday Deals). They are not regular prices, have not been re-verified since, and will change. Reported ages are sample inputs. A research example, not a claim determination.

# GE dryer: age research

**Reported age: 2025. Researched age: model built December 2019 to August 2023. Status: Reported Age Requires Review.** GE lists no production of this model after August 2023, and its date code makes 2025 the letter A, outside the window. But 2025 could be a purchase or installation date rather than a manufacture date, and no conclusion is drawn about the accuracy of the report. The nameplate serial number or other appropriate documentation is needed to resolve the original unit's age; none was available, so no unit date and no single ACV is stated. Taken as a build year, 2025 would mean 0.9 to 1.9 years and an illustrative ACV of $771 to $840; GE's window supports $419 to $678 (13-year straight line, $899.00, no condition adjustment).

**GE GFD65ESSNWW** (original): manufactured December 2019 to August 2023, per GE's Owner Center.
**GE GFD65ESSVWW** (successor): September 2023 to present. 101 of GE's 108 published specification fields are identical; no functional difference was found. $899.00 at GE.com and Home Depot on Nov 9, 2026 (sale event; GE list price $1,249.00).

**GE's date code.** First letter is the month, second the year; GE's chart repeats each year letter every 12 years (GE's example: "GA" is April 2001 or April 2013). Inside this model's window only M (December 2019), R (2020), S (2021), T (2022) and V (January to August 2023) are possible.

What each possible year letter means (illustrative: 13-year straight line, replacement value $899.00)

| YEAR LETTER | UNIT AGE ON NOV 9, 2026 | DEPRECIATION | ILLUSTRATIVE ACV |
|---|---|---|---|
| M (December 2019) | 6.9 years | about 53% | $419 to $425 |
| R (2020) | 5.9 to 6.9 years | 45.0% to 52.7% | $425 to $494 |
| S (2021) | 4.9 to 5.9 years | 37.4% to 45.0% | $494 to $563 |
| T (2022) | 3.9 to 4.9 years | 29.7% to 37.3% | $563 to $632 |
| V (January to August 2023) | 3.2 to 3.9 years | 24.6% to 29.7% | $632 to $678 |
| **Whole window, no serial** | **3.2 to 6.9 years** | **24.6% to 53.4%** | **$419 to $678** |

**Estimated ACV (2 of 3 items).** Refrigerator $1,023.07 (assumed 6.0-year age; no serial number was available) plus dryer $419 to $678 (GE window) = $1,442 to $1,701, 13-year straight line, no condition adjustment. No television ACV: no supported useful life. Uses illustrative depreciation: an estimate, not a verified full-claim ACV or claim valuation.

**Why the window matters.** The letter R alone can mean 2008 (about 18 years, $0 before any client floor) or 2020 ($425 to $494). The model window makes the finding defensible.

## How the research is done

- **Original first.** The original item is identified and its specifications documented from manufacturer sources before any replacement is considered.
- **Evidence is labelled.** Documented by the manufacturer, measured by a third party, observed at a retailer on a stated date, assumed for illustration, or not determined.
- **Prices are dated.** Documented market prices are observed selling prices, shown with the retailer and date; they are not averages. Manufacturer list prices are shown separately, and retailer crossed-out prices are not treated as regular prices.
- **Limits are stated.** Same-brand search, one date, promotional pricing, and every unresolved alternative are disclosed. Age is marked verified only where unit-level evidence exists; none of these three examples has a serial number.
- **ACV is transparent.** Replacement value, age evidence, method, useful life (a general published guideline) and condition are all shown. Item Assist does not determine depreciation, final ACV, coverage or settlement.

**Sources:** Samsung specification sheets and U.S. launch pricing (news.samsung.com); Best Buy and Samsung.com product pages and Home Depot (observed November 9, 2026); RTINGS Q80A review; GE Appliances Owner Center, date-code chart and product pages; ENERGY STAR product finder; NAHB / Bank of America Home Equity, Study of Life Expectancy of Home Components (2007). Full list with links: itemassist.com/report

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